

سنة النبي
للإمام أبي جريح الطبري

The Explicit Sunnah

ibn Jarīr at-Ṭabarī



سنة الدين
للإمام أبي جريح الطبري

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Translator's Introduction

All praise is due to Allāh, the Lord of the Worlds. We praise Him, we seek His aid, and we seek His forgiveness. We seek refuge in Allāh from the evils of our souls and the evils of our actions. Whomsoever Allāh guides, none can misguide him, and whomsoever He leaves to stray, none can guide him. I bear witness that there is no deity worthy of worship except Allāh alone, without any partners, and I bear witness that Muḥammad (صلى الله عليه وسلم) is His servant and Messenger.

To proceed:

Verily, the greatest blessing Allāh (سبحانه وتعالى) has bestowed upon this Ummah is the blessing of Islām and the Sunnah. The foundation of this Dīn rests upon the pure, unadulterated ‘*Aqīdah* (creed) of the Companions and those who followed them in goodness—the *Salaf aṣ-Ṣāliḥ* (the Righteous Predecessors). Safety from the deviations of the intellect, the corruptions of philosophy, and the whims of the people of innovation lies solely in clinging strictly to the texts of the Book and the Sunnah, upon the understanding of the early generations.

Allāh (عز وجل) has made this obligation manifestly clear in His Book, stating:

{And, [moreover], this is My path, which is straight, so follow it; and do not follow [other] ways, for you will be separated from His way. This has He instructed you that you may become righteous.} [6:153]

Likewise, Allāh (سبحانه وتعالى) warned against opposing the way of the Companions:

{And whoever opposes the Messenger after guidance has become clear to him and follows other than the way of the believers - We will give him what he has taken and drive him into Hell, and evil it is as a destination.} [4:115]

The Imāms of the *Salaf* recognized that salvation is tied to following the Sunnah and abandoning newly-invented matters. The Imām of Dār al-Hijrah, Mālik bin Anas (d. 179H) - رحمه الله - famously stated:

"The Sunnah is like the Ark of Nūh. Whoever embarks upon it is saved, and whoever turns away from it is drowned."¹

And the great Imām of Shām, al-Awzā'ī (d. 157H) - رحمه الله - advised:

"Patiently restrict yourself to the Sunnah, stop where the people (the Companions) stopped, say what they said, and refrain from what they refrained from. And traverse the path of your Righteous Predecessors (Salaf aṣ-Ṣāliḥ), for what was sufficient for them is sufficient for you."²

It is precisely within this context of preserving and clarifying the orthodox creed of *Ahl us-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah* that this magnificent and precise treatise was authored. The author is none other than the Mountain of Knowledge, the Imām, the Mujtahid, the Mufasssir (Exegete), the Historian, Abū Ja'far Muḥammad bin Jarīr aṭ-Ṭabarī (d. 310H) - may Allāh shower him with His vast mercy.

Imām aṭ-Ṭabarī is universally recognized for his monumental works, *Jāmi' al-Bayān* (his Tafsīr) and *Tārīkh ar-Rusul wal-Mulūk*. However, towards the latter part of his life in Baghdād, he was subjected to false accusations and trials. The people of desires—and extreme factions who ascribed themselves to the Sunnah but were ignorant of its reality—falsely accused him of various deviations, including hidden Shī'ism and irregularities in creed.

To completely demolish these falsehoods and vindicate himself before Allāh and then the people, Imām aṭ-Ṭabarī authored this treatise: ***Ṣarīḥ as-Sunnah*** (The Clear, Explicit Sunnah).

¹ Tārīkh Dimashq 12275

² Reported by al-Ājurri in ash-Sharī'ah, p. 58

In this brief work, the Imām lays down the definitive, explicit stance of *Ahl us-Sunnah* regarding the foundational matters of creed that were contested by the Jahmiyyah, the Mu‘tazilah, the Qadariyyah, and the Rāfiḍah. He resolutely affirms:

1. That the Qur’ān is the uncreated Speech of Allāh.
2. The Ru’yah³.
3. The reality of *al-Qadar* (the Divine Pre-decree), both its good and its bitter consequences.
4. The excellence and ranking of the Companions of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم), specifically the Khulafā’ ar-Rāshidūn.

As the translator, my objective has been to render the Imām’s words into precise English, whilst strictly maintaining the theological terminologies of the *Salaf*. I have avoided the convoluted and philosophical phrasing favored by the *Mutakallimūn*⁴, in order to preserve the purity, simplicity, and decisive nature of the Imām's original Arabic.

It is my hope that this translation serves as a clarification for the English-speaking Muslim, connecting them directly to the pristine ‘*Aqīdah* of the early Imāms, free from the taints of later scholastic theology (*‘ilm al-Kalām*).

We ask Allāh, the Most High, to reward Imām aṭ-Ṭabarī abundantly for his defense of the Sunnah, to make this humble effort purely for His Noble Face, and to keep us firm upon the *Manhaj* of the *Salaf aṣ-Ṣāliḥ* until the day we meet Him.

Abū Mundhir al-Ruwāndī

Muḥarram 1448/July 2026

³ the believers seeing Allāh with their physical eyes in the Hereafter

⁴ the people of theological rhetoric

Biography of The Author

His Lineage, Status, and Formative Years

He is Muḥammad bin Jarīr bin Yazīd bin Kathīr, the Imām of Knowledge, the *Mujtahid*, the Scholar of his Era, Abū Jaʿfar aṭ-Ṭabarī. He is the author of exquisite, unprecedented compilations, from the people of Āmul, Ṭabaristān.

His birth was in the year 224H. He set out to seek knowledge after the year 240H, and he journeyed extensively, meeting the noble men [of knowledge]. He was among the singular, unique individuals of the age in terms of knowledge (*ʿilm*), sheer intelligence (*dhakāʾ*), and a prolific abundance of authorship. Rarely do the eyes see the likes of him.

An Elevated Prophetic Ḥadīth via His Chain

Aḥmad bin Hibatullāh informed us, from Abū Rūḥ al-Harawī: Zāhir al-Mustamlī informed us, Muḥammad bin ʿAbd ar-Raḥmān informed us, Abū ʿAmr bin Ḥamdān informed us, Muḥammad bin Jarīr al-Faqīh and Muḥammad bin Ishāq ath-Thaqafi both said: Aḥmad bin Manīʿ narrated to us, al-Ḥusayn bin Muḥammad narrated to us, Isrāʾīl narrated to us, from Simāk, from ʿIkrimah, from Ibn ʿAbbās: That the Prophet (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said to Ḍubāʿah: "Perform Ḥajj and make a condition that my place of exiting the state of Iḥrām is wherever You prevent me." [Imām adh-Dhahabī said:] A *ḥasan gharīb* (good, solitary) ḥadīth, from the most elevated (shortest chain) of what I possess from Ibn Jarīr.

His Teachers and Shaykhs

He heard [the Ḥadīth] from: Muḥammad bin ʿAbd al-Malik bin Abī ash-Shawārib, Ismāʿīl bin Mūsā as-Suddī, Ishāq bin Abī Isrāʾīl, Muḥammad bin Abī Maʿshar—who narrated to him concerning the military expeditions (*al-Maghāzī*) from his father, Muḥammad bin Ḥumayd ar-Rāzī, Aḥmad bin Manīʿ, Abū Kurayb Muḥammad bin al-

‘Alā’, Hannād bin as-Sarī, Abū Hammām as-Sakūnī, Muḥammad bin ‘Abd al-A‘lā aṣ-Ṣan‘ānī, Bundār, Muḥammad bin al-Muthannā, Sufyān bin Wakī‘, al-Faḍl bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ, ‘Abdah bin ‘Abdullāh aṣ-Ṣaffār, Salm bin Junādah, Yūnus bin ‘Abd al-A‘lā, and Ya‘qūb ad-Dawraqī.

[He also heard from:] Aḥmad bin al-Miqdām al-‘Ijlī, Bishr bin Mu‘ādh al-‘Aqadī, Sawwār bin ‘Abdullāh al-‘Anbarī, ‘Amr bin ‘Alī al-Fallās, Mujāhid bin Mūsā, Tamīm bin al-Muntaṣir, al-Ḥasan bin ‘Arafah, Muhannā bin Yaḥyā, ‘Alī bin Sahl ar-Ramlī, Hārūn bin Ishāq al-Hamdānī, al-‘Abbās bin al-Walīd al-‘Udhri, Sa‘īd bin ‘Amr as-Sakūnī, Aḥmad bin Akhī Ibn Wahb, Muḥammad bin Ma‘mar al-Qaysī, Ibrāhīm bin Sa‘īd al-Jawharī, Naṣr bin ‘Alī al-Jahḍamī, Muḥammad bin ‘Abdullāh bin Bazī‘, Ṣāliḥ bin Mismār al-Marwazī, Sa‘īd bin Yaḥyā al-Umawī, Naṣr bin ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān al-Awdī, ‘Abd al-Ḥamīd bin Bayān as-Sukkarī, Aḥmad bin Abī Surayj ar-Rāzī, al-Ḥasan bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ al-Bazzār, Abū ‘Ammār al-Ḥusayn bin Ḥurayth, and multitudes besides them.

He settled in Baghdād towards the latter part of his affair, and he was from the major Imāms of independent juristic reasoning (*min kibār a’immat il-Ijtihād*).

His Students and Those Who Narrated From Him

Those who narrated from him: Abū Shu‘ayb ‘Abdullāh bin al-Ḥasan al-Ḥarrānī—and he was older than him, Abū al-Qāsim aṭ-Ṭabarānī, Aḥmad bin Kāmil al-Qāḍī, Abū Bakr ash-Shāfi‘ī, Abū Aḥmad bin ‘Adī, Makhlad bin Ja‘far al-Bāqarḥī, the Judge (*al-Qāḍī*) Abū Muḥammad bin Zabīr, Aḥmad bin al-Qāsim al-Khashshāb, Abū ‘Amr Muḥammad bin Aḥmad bin Ḥamdān, Abū Ja‘far Aḥmad bin ‘Alī al-Kātib, ‘Abd al-Ghaffār bin ‘Ubaydillāh al-Ḥuḍaynī, Abū al-Mufaḍḍal Muḥammad bin ‘Abdillāh ash-Shaybānī, al-Mu‘allā bin Sa‘īd, and a great creation [i.e., countless others].

The Praise of the Scholars For Him

Abū Sa‘īd bin Yūnus said:

“Muḥammad bin Jarīr is from the people of Āmul. He wrote [knowledge] in Egypt and returned to Baghdād. **He authored excellent works which indicate the vast expanse of his knowledge.**”

Al-Khaṭīb [al-Baghdādī] said:

“He was one of the Imāms of the scholars. His statement was judged by, and his opinion was returned to, due to his knowledge and his virtue. He gathered from the sciences that which none of the people of his era shared with him. He was a Ḥāfiẓ of the Book of Allāh, deeply cognizant of the *Qirā’āt* (modes of recitation), insightful regarding the meanings, a *Faqīh* (jurist) concerning the rulings of the Qur’ān, and an expert scholar of the *Sunan* (Prophetic traditions) and its pathways—its authentic (*ṣaḥīḥ*) and its defective (*saqīm*), its abrogating (*nāsikh*) and its abrogated (*mansūkh*). He was profoundly aware of the statements of the Companions and *Tābi‘īn*, and cognizant of the histories of the people and their chronicles.

He has the famous book regarding 'The Histories of the Nations and their Chronicles', and he has the book of 'Tafsīr', the likes of which has never been authored. He also has a book he named 'Tahdhīb al-Āthār'; I have not seen anything else equivalent to it in its meaning, however, he did not complete it. And he has many books concerning the foundations of Fiqh (*Uṣūl*) and its branches (*Furū‘*) and [his own] selections from the statements of the jurists. And he was isolated in holding certain juristic issues which were memorized from him.”

I [Imām adh-Dhahabī] say:

“He was trustworthy and precise (*thiqah*), truthful (*ṣādiq*), a Ḥāfiẓ, a leading figure (*ra’san*) in *Tafsīr*, an Imām in *Fiqh*, Consensus (*Ijmā‘*) and Differing (*Ikhtilāf*), an Erudite Scholar (*Allāmah*) in history and the chronicles of the people, and cognizant of the *Qirā’āt*, the Arabic language, and other than that.”

He recited the Qur’ān in Beirut to al-‘Abbās bin al-Walīd.

Abū Muḥammad ʿAbdullāh bin Aḥmad bin Jaʿfar al-Farghānī mentioned that his birthplace was in Āmul.

It is said: Verily, al-Muktafī [the Caliph] wanted to endow a *Waqf* (religious endowment) based upon the gathered consensus of the scholars. So, Ibn Jarīr was brought to him, and he dictated a book to them for that purpose. A reward [monetary prize] was brought out for him, but he refused to accept it. It was said to him: "It is strictly necessary [to accept something]..."

His Unadulterated Salafī Creed Regarding the Attributes

Abū Jaʿfar Muḥammad bin Jarīr aṭ-Ṭabarī informed us of his *ʿAqīdah* (creed), and from it is [his statement]:

“And it is sufficient for a person to know that his Lord is the One who **ascended over the Throne**. Whoever surpasses that [by delving into philosophical rhetoric] has indeed failed and suffered a loss.”

[Imām adh-Dhahabī says:] And this 'Tafsīr' of this Imām is replete—concerning the verses of the Attributes (*Āyāt aṣ-Ṣifāt*)—with the statements of the *Salaf* upon [the methodology of] affirmation (*Ithbāt*) for them; not upon negation (*Nafy*) and false interpretation (*Taʿwīl*), and [affirming] that they do not resemble the attributes of the creation whatsoever.

The Elegy of Ibn Durayd

Abū al-Faḍl Aḥmad bin Hibatullāh informed us, al-Musallam bin Aḥmad al-Māzinī informed us, ʿAlī bin al-Ḥasan al-Ḥāfiẓ informed us in Baʿlabakk in the year 551H, ʿAlī bin Ibrāhīm al-Ḥusaynī informed us, Abū Bakr al-Ḥāfiẓ informed us, saying: I read to Abū al-Ḥasan Hibatullāh bin al-Ḥasan al-Adīb, [the poem] belonging to Ibn Durayd. I [adh-Dhahabī] say: He is eulogizing Ibn Jarīr:

You will never be able to delay the command of Allāh, So seek the aid of patience or feel the pain of sorrow.

And flee to the shelter of submission, and be pleased With whatever the Dominant Overlord (al-Muḥaymin) decrees, whether disliked or beloved.

Indeed, the true calamity is not wealth that the hands of worldly events shake, Scattering and pruning it.

Nor is it the separation of close companions whom parting takes away, Leaving the rope of connection severed.

Rather, it is the loss of one by whose death The light of guidance and the splendor of knowledge have been stripped away.

Verily, death did not merely destroy a man through him; Rather, it destroyed an erected signpost of the Religion.

Demise gifted to the soil, when it took his lifeblood, A star that was poured down upon those who show enmity to the truth.

The era used to have pure drinking sources through him, But now it has become murky and frowning.

Never! By his radiant days which were made A light for knowledge and Miḥrābs for piety.

Time will never reveal an equal to him, As long as the Ḥajj stops the riders at the sacred markers.

Whenever he drew his intellect to clarify a problematic issue, He returned its obscured path to becoming a clear, trodden road.

He would not allow idle speech or foul words to enter his hearing, Nor did he commit that which would bring upon him reproach.

His admonitions polish away the rust of the hearts, Just as the radiant light of dawn drives away the darkness.

The one who praises him is not safe from inability and shortcoming, And he does not fear being belied for his elaboration.

The plots of land of Allāh's earth wished they could be made A grave for him, so that his body would grant them fragrance.

Your life was a light for the world and its inhabitants, And now that light has been veiled from it.

If the earth knew who it had buried, its regions Would have humbled themselves for you in reverence and welcome.

If they mourn you, then their thrones have indeed collapsed, And knowledge has become the subject of elegies and mourning.

*And from the wonders that time has brought— And time does indeed clarify wonders for us—
Is that the obscure depths of the earth have folded you in its covers, While you used to fill its plains and its rocky terrains.*

His Physical Description and Death

Aḥmad bin Kāmil said:

“Ibn Jarīr passed away on the evening of Sunday, with two days remaining from the month of Shawwāl, in the year 310H. He was buried in his home in the courtyard of Ya‘qūb—meaning in Baghdād.”

He also said:

“And he did not dye his white hair, and the black [hair] within it was abundant. He was brown-skinned leaning towards a darker complexion (*al-udmah*), having large wide eyes (*a‘yan*), and a slender body.”

Translated and compiled from the text of ‘Siyar A‘lām an-Nubalā’ (14/268-282)

Translation of Ṣarīḥ as-Sunnah

Authors Introduction

In the Name of Allāh, the Most Merciful, the Bestower of Mercy. May Allāh send blessings upon our leader Muḥammad and his family. There is no might nor power except by Allāh, the Most High, the Supreme.

The Shaykh, Abū Muḥammad al-Ḥasan bin ‘Alī bin al-Ḥusayn bin al-Ḥasan al-Asadī informed us: My grandfather Abū al-Qāsim al-Ḥusayn bin al-Ḥasan bin Muḥammad al-Asadī informed us: Abū al-Qāsim ‘Alī bin Abī al-‘Alā’ informed us: Abū Muḥammad ‘Abd ar-Raḥmān bin ‘Uthmān bin Abī Naṣr informed us: Abū Sa‘īd ‘Amr bin Muḥammad bin Yaḥyā ad-Dīnawarī informed us, saying: It was read upon Abū Ja‘far Muḥammad bin Jarīr aṭ-Ṭabarī while I was listening:

All praise is due to Allāh, the One who grants triumph to the truth and aids it, and the One who nullifies falsehood and obliterates it; the One who chose Islām as a Religion for Himself. He commanded it and encompassed it, He took charge of its preservation and guaranteed its dominance over all other religions, even if the polytheists detest it. Then, He chose from His creation Messengers, dispatching them to call to Him. He commanded them to establish it and to be patient with whatever befell them concerning it from the ignorant among His creation. He tested them with various types of trials and afflicted them with different forms of tribulations—as an honoring for them, not a humiliation, and as an elevation in nobility, not a loss. He raised some of them above others in degrees; thus, the highest of them in rank with Him were those most resolute in execution despite the severity of the trials, the

closest to Him in proximity, and the best in conveying what He sent them with, alongside the magnitude of the affliction.

Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) says in His decisive Book to His Prophet (عز وجل):

فَاصْبِرْ كَمَا صَبَرَ أُولُوا الْعِزْمِ مِنَ الرُّسُلِ

{Therefore, be patient (O Muḥammad) as those with firm will and resolution among the Messengers were patient (after they were rejected).} [46:35]

And He said to him (صلى الله عليه وسلم) and to his followers, may the pleasure of Allāh be upon them:

أَمْ حَسِبْتُمْ أَنْ تُدْخِلُوا الْجَنَّةَ وَلَمَّا يَأْتِكُمْ مَثَلُ الَّذِينَ خَلَوْا مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ مَسْتَهْمُ الْبِئْسَاءِ وَالضَّرَّاءُ وَزُلْزِلُوا حَتَّى يَقُولَ
الرَّسُولُ وَالَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا مَعَهُ مَتَى نَصْرُ اللَّهِ أَلَا إِنَّ نَصْرَ اللَّهِ قَرِيبٌ

{Or do you think that you will enter Paradise while such [trial] has not yet come to you as came to those who passed on before you? They were touched by poverty and hardship and were shaken until [even their] messenger and those who believed with him said, "When is the help of Allah?" Unquestionably, the help of Allah is near.} [2:214]

And He said:

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا أَذْكُرُوا نِعْمَةَ اللَّهِ عَلَيْكُمْ إِذْ جَاءَتْكُمْ جُنُودٌ فَأَرْسَلْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ رِيحًا وَجُنُودًا لَمْ تَرَوْهَا وَكَانَ اللَّهُ بِمَا تَعْمَلُونَ بَصِيرًا
﴿١﴾ إِذْ جَاءَكُمْ مِنْ فَوْقِكُمْ وَمِنْ أَسْفَلَ مِنْكُمْ وَإِذْ زَاغَتِ الْأَبْصَارُ وَبَلَغَتِ الْقُلُوبُ الْحَنَاجِرَ وَتَظُنُّونَ بِاللَّهِ الظُّنُونًا
﴿٢﴾ هُنَالِكَ ابْتُلِيَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَزُلْزِلُوا زِلْزَالًا شَدِيدًا

{O you who have believed, remember the favor of Allah upon you when armies came to [attack] you and We sent upon them a wind and armies [of angels] you

did not see. And ever is Allah, of what you do, Seeing. ﴿٩﴾ [Remember] when they came at you from above you and from below you, and when eyes shifted [in fear], and hearts reached the throats and you assumed about Allah [various] assumptions. ﴿١٠﴾ There the believers were tested and shaken with a severe shaking.} [33:9-11]

وَإِذْ يَقُولُ الْمُنَافِقُونَ وَالَّذِينَ فِي قُلُوبِهِم مَّرَضٌ

{“And [remember] when the hypocrites and those in whose hearts is disease said,

Up to:

”غُرُورًا

delusion,”} [33:12]⁵

And He, Exalted is His mention, said:

أَحْسِبَ النَّاسُ أَنْ يُتْرَكُوا أَنْ يَقُولُوا ءَامَنَّا وَهُمْ لَا يُفْتَنُونَ ﴿٢﴾ وَلَقَدْ فَتَنَّا الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ فَلَيَعْلَمَنَّ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ صَدَقُوا وَلَيَعْلَمَنَّ الْكَاذِبِينَ

{Do the people think that they will be left to say, "We believe" and they will not be tried? ﴿٢﴾ But We have certainly tried those before them, and Allah will surely make evident those who are truthful, and He will surely make evident the liars.} [29:2-3]

Thus, He—Exalted is His praise—did not leave anyone from His honored Messengers, nor His drawn-near close allies (Awliyā’), free from a trial in the immediate worldly life

⁵ Translator's Note: The printed Arabic manuscript contains a severe typographical error here, incorrectly attributing these consecutive verses to Sūrah al-Anfāl 49 and Sūrah an-Nisā’ 120. They are, in fact, consecutive verses from Sūrah al-Aḥzāb

prior to the Hereafter; so that through his patience upon it, he would merit from his Lord the honor He prepared for him, and the rank with Him that He decreed for him.

Then, He—the Exalted, Majestic and Lofty is His mention—made the scholars of the Ummah of every Prophet He sent the inheritors after him, and the maintainers of the Religion after his extraction to Him and his taking [in death]. [They are] the defenders of its handholds and its causes, the protectors of its signposts and its legislations, those who stand before it against whoever seeks to transgress against it and oppose it, and those who repel from it the plot of Shayṭān and his misguidance. He favored them with the nobility of knowledge, and honored them with the dignity of forbearance. He made them signposts for the Religion and its people, a lighthouse for Islām and guidance, leaders for the creation, and Imāms and masters for the servants. To them is their refuge in times of need, and through them is their seeking of relief during a calamity. The evil of what they [the ignorant] intend from themselves, which they direct [towards the scholars], does not deter them from showing affection and compassion to them. Nor does the ugliness of what they commit of the unlawful prevent them from having tenderness and mercy towards them—[this is out of] seeking Allāh’s abundant reward regarding them, and aiming to attain the pleasure of Allāh by taking to the path of grace towards them.

Then, He—Exalted is His praise and mention—made the scholars of the Ummah of our Prophet (صلى الله عليه وسلم) from the most virtuous of the scholars of the nations that passed before it in what has occurred; He portioned out for them comprehensive stations, degrees, ranks, and honors, and granted them an abundant share and portion of it. [This is] despite Allāh testing its most virtuous ones with its beneficial ones, and His testing of its chosen ones with its wicked ones, and its elevated ones with its lowly and despicable ones. Yet, what they were tested with by them did not deter them, nor did what they faced for the sake of Allāh from them stop them from being sincere advisors for Allāh concerning His servants and His lands during the days of their lives. Rather, they would meet their ignorance with their knowledge, approach their

foolishness with their forbearance, and counter their deficiencies with their virtue. In fact, a senior one amongst them would not be satisfied with the virtue he advanced for himself with Allāh during his lifetime; rather, he stored away from it the most noble of treasures with Him before his death, so that their legacies would remain for those after them enduring upon the days, and serving as a guide for them to right guidance. May Allāh reward them on behalf of the Ummah of their Prophet with the best of what He rewards a scholar of an Ummah on their behalf, and may He grant them the most abundant of rewards. May He make us from those for whom He has apportioned the righteous things He apportioned for them, join us in their ranks, honor us with loving them and recognizing their rights, and seek refuge for us and all the Muslims from the destructive whims (*Ahwā'*) and misguiding opinions (*Ārā'*). Indeed, He is the Hearer of supplication.

Then, continuously, after the passing of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) to his path, events occur in every era, and calamities descend in every age. The ignorant person flees during them to the scholar, so the scholar lifts the darkness from the ignorant through the knowledge that Allāh granted him and favored him with over others—whether by a narration (*Athar*) or by sound reflection (*Naẓar*). So, from the earliest of events after the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) concerning the incidents wherein his Ummah disputed, was their differing regarding the best of them after him (صلى الله عليه وسلم), the most deserving of them for the Imāmate, and the most worthy of them for the Khilāfah.

Then, the speech concerning the actions of the servants, their obedience, and their disobedience; are they by the Decree (*Qaḍā'*) of Allāh and His Pre-estimation (*Qadar*), or is the affair in that ambiguity delegated [to them]?

Then, the speech concerning Faith (*Īmān*): is it speech and action, or is it speech without action? And does it increase and decrease, or is there no increase to it and no decrease?

Then, the speech concerning the Qurʾān: is it created (*makhlūq*) or uncreated (*ghayr makhlūq*)?

Then, the believers seeing their Lord, the Exalted, on the Day of Resurrection.

Then, in this era of ours, foolishness has emerged into which the people of ignorance, stupidity, the simpletons of the Ummah, and the riffraff have plunged. Counting them brings fatigue, and enumerating them causes weariness. In it is the speech concerning the Name of a thing: is it the thing itself, or is it other than it?

And we shall clarify the correct statement regarding that with us, if Allāh the Exalted wills, and with Allāh lies all success.

The Statement Concerning the Qurʾān and That It Is the Speech of Allāh

So the first of what we shall begin speaking about from that, according to us: The Qurʾān is the Speech of Allāh (*Kalāmullāh*) and His Revelation; since it is from the meanings of His *Tawḥīd*. Thus, the correct statement regarding that with us is that it is: **The Speech of Allāh, uncreated (*ghayr makhlūq*)**. However it is written, wherever it is recited, and in whichever place it is read. In the heaven it is found, and in the earth wherever it is memorized; in the Preserved Tablet (*al-Lawḥ al-Maḥfūz*) it was written, and in the tablets of the children in schools it is drawn; in stone it is engraved, or in paper it is written, or in the heart it is memorized, and with the tongue it is articulated.

So whoever says other than that, or claims that there is a Qurʾān in the earth or in the heaven other than the Qurʾān which we recite with our tongues and write in our Muṣḥafs, or believes other than that in his heart, or conceals it within his soul, or speaks it with his tongue adopting it as his religion—then he is a disbeliever in Allāh, his blood is lawful, he is completely innocent of Allāh, and Allāh is completely innocent of him, due to the statement of Allāh (عز وجل):

بَلْ هُوَ قُرْآنٌ مَّجِيدٌ ﴿١٩﴾ فِي لَوْحٍ مَّحْفُوظٍ

{But (rather), this is a Glorious Qur'ān (full of guidance, honour and blessing for those who follow it). ﴿١٩﴾ (Inscribed) in a Preserved Tablet (protected from alteration).} [85:21–22]

And He said, and His statement is the Truth (عز وجل):

وَإِنْ أَحَدٌ مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ اسْتَجَارَكَ فَأَجِرْهُ حَتَّى يَسْمَعَ كَلِمَ اللَّهِ

{And if any one of the polytheists seeks your protection, then grant him protection so that he may hear the words of Allah.} [9:6]

Thus, He, Exalted is His praise, informed that it is written in the Preserved Tablet, and that it is heard from the tongue of Muḥammad (صلى الله عليه وسلم). And it is one Qur'ān: heard from Muḥammad (صلى الله عليه وسلم), written in the Preserved Tablet, and likewise, it is memorized in the chests, and recited upon the tongues of the elders and the youth.

Abū Ja'far said: “So whoever narrates from us, or relates from us, or fabricates against us, claiming that we said anything other than this, then upon him is the curse of Allāh and His wrath, and the curse of those who curse, the angels, and all of mankind. May Allāh not accept from him any obligatory or supererogatory act, and may He tear away his veil, and expose him before all witnesses on a Day when the excuse of the wrongdoers will not benefit them, and for them is the curse, and for them is the evil home.”

Mūsā bin Sahl ar-Ramlī narrated to us: Mūsā bin Dāwūd narrated to us: Ma'bad Abū 'Abd ar-Raḥmān narrated to us, from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār ad-Duhnī, who said: I

said to Ja'far bin Muḥammad (رضي الله عنه): "Verily, they ask about the Qur'ān: is it created or a creator?" He replied: "It is neither a creator nor created; rather, it is the Speech of Allāh (عز وجل)." ⁶

And Muḥammad bin Manṣūr al-Āmulī narrated to me: al-Ḥakam bin Muḥammad al-Āmulī Abū Marwān narrated to us: Ibn 'Uyaynah narrated to us, saying: I heard 'Amr bin Dīnār saying: "I met our Shaykhs for seventy years, all saying: **'The Qur'ān is the Speech of Allāh; from Him it began, and to Him it shall return.'**"

The Statement Concerning the Seeing of Allāh (عز وجل)

⁶ This narration is authentic and famous (*ṣaḥīḥ mashhūr*) from Ja'far bin Muḥammad (رضي الله عنه). It has been collected via multiple pathways (*ṭuruq*) revolving primarily around Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār ad-Duhnī, as well as other corroborating routes. 'Abdullāh bin Aḥmad bin Ḥanbal collected it in *as-Sunnah* (1/151-152) through three distinct routes: from his father (Imām Aḥmad), from Mūsā bin Dāwūd, from Abū 'Abd ar-Raḥmān Ma'bad, from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār ad-Duhnī; from Ismā'il bin 'Ubayd bin Abī Karīmah, from a named man, from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār; and from 'Abbās bin 'Abd al-Aẓīm al-'Anbarī, from Ruwaym bin Yazīd al-Muqri', from Ma'bad bin Rāshid al-Kūfī, from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār. Ṣāliḥ bin Aḥmad bin Ḥanbal also collected it in *Sīrat al-Imām Aḥmad* (pp. 69-70) via the route of his father, from Mūsā bin Dāwūd. Within these transmissions, Imām Aḥmad bin Ḥanbal validated the narrator Ma'bad, stating: "I have seen this Ma'bad, and there is no harm in him. My father praised him, and he used to give fatwa according to the opinion of Ibn Abī Laylā." Furthermore, al-Ājurri collected it in *ash-Sharī'ah* via two routes: from Aḥmad bin Abī 'Awf, from Suwayd bin Sa'īd, directly from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār; and from Muḥammad bin Makhlad, from Abū Dāwūd, from al-Ḥasan bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ al-Bazzār, from Ma'bad Abū 'Abd ar-Raḥmān—declaring him trustworthy—from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār. Ibn Baṭṭah likewise collected it in *al-Ibānah al-Kubrā* (5/285-288) via four chains of transmission, all of them converging upon Mūsā bin Dāwūd and al-Ḥasan bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ al-Bazzār, from Ma'bad, from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār, and he brought an additional corroborating route (6/5-6) from Mas'adah bin Ṣadaqah al-Baṣrī, from Ja'far bin Muḥammad, from his father. Similarly, al-Lālikā'i extensively collected it in *Sharḥ Uṣūl I'tiqād Ahl as-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah* (2/267-270) via six distinct routes returning to Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār through Mūsā bin Dāwūd, al-Ḥasan bin aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ, Ruwaym bin Yazīd, and Yaḥyā bin 'Abd al-Ḥamīd al-Ḥimmānī. He further cited two external corroborating routes (*shawāhid*) originally mentioned by Ibn Abī Ḥātim: the first from Mūsā bin Ja'far, who narrated it from his father, Ja'far bin Muḥammad, and the second from Marwān bin Mu'āwiyah al-Fazārī, who heard it directly from Ja'far. Finally, al-Bayhaqī collected it in *Kitāb al-I'tiqād* via the route of Mūsā bin Dāwūd, from Ma'bad, and consolidating the strength of this narration, he stated: "And it was likewise narrated by Suwayd bin Sa'īd from Mu'āwiyah bin 'Ammār from Ja'far aṣ-Ṣādiq, and it was likewise narrated by Qays bin ar-Rabī' from Ja'far. Thus, it is an authentic, famous narration (*ṣaḥīḥ mashhūr*) from Ja'far... and it is the madhhab of all the people of knowledge, classically and modernly."

As for the correct statement concerning the believers seeing their Lord (عز وجل) on the Day of Resurrection, and it is our Religion by which we worship Allāh, and upon which we found *Ahl us-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah*, then it is: That the people of Paradise will see Him, based upon what the narrations have authenticated from the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم).

Abū as-Sā'ib Salm bin Junādah narrated to us: Ibn Fuḍayl narrated to us; and Tamīm bin al-Muntaṣir and Mujāhid bin Mūsā narrated to us, Tamīm said: Yazīd informed us, and Mujāhid said: Yazīd bin Hārūn narrated to us; and Ibn aṣ-Ṣabbāḥ narrated to us: Sufyān, and Marwān bin Mu'āwiyah, and Yazīd bin Hārūn narrated to us, all of them from Ismā'īl bin Abī Khālīd, from Qays bin Abī Ḥāzim, from Jarīr bin 'Abdullāh, who said: We were sitting with the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم), so he looked at the moon on the night of the full moon and said: "You people will see your Lord as you see this full moon, and you will have no trouble in seeing Him, so if you can avoid missing (through sleep or business, etc.) a prayer before sunrise (Fajr) and a prayer before sunset (ʿAsr) you must do so."⁷ Then the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) recited:

فَأَصْبِرْ عَلَىٰ مَا يَقُولُونَ وَسَبِّحْ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّكَ قَبْلَ طُلُوعِ الشَّمْسِ وَقَبْلَ الْغُرُوبِ

{So bear patiently (O Muḥammad) over what they say of (rejection, lies and fabrications), and glorify (Allāh) with praise of your Lord before the rising of the sun and before its setting—(the dawn, noon and afternoon prayers).} [50:39]

And the wording of the ḥadīth is the wording of the ḥadīth of Mujāhid. Yazīd said: "Whoever belies this ḥadīth, he is completely innocent of Allāh and His Messenger." He **swore** to this more than once. And I [aṭ-Ṭabarī] say: The Messenger of Allāh spoke the truth, and Yazīd spoke the truth and uttered the truth.

⁷ Saḥīḥ al-Bukhārī 7434

The Statement Concerning the Actions of the Servants

As for the correct statement with us regarding what is differed upon concerning the actions of the servants, their good deeds, and their evil deeds: Verily, all of that is from Allāh the Exalted, and Allāh, the Transcendent, is its Pre-decreer and its Regulator. Nothing occurs except by His permission, and nothing happens except by His Will. To Him belongs the creation and the command, just as He wills.

Ziyād bin Yaḥyā al-Ḥassānī and ‘Ubaydullāh bin Muḥammad al-Firyābī narrated to me, both saying: ‘Abdullāh bin Maymūn narrated to us, Ja‘far bin Muḥammad narrated to us, from his father, from Jābir bin ‘Abdullāh, who said: The Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said: ” **A servant (of Allah) shall not believe until he believes in Al-Qadar (pre-decree) , its good and its bad, such that he knows that what struck him would not have missed him, and that what missed him would not have struck him**”⁸ The wording is for the ḥadīth of Abū al-Khaṭṭāb Ziyād bin ‘Abdullāh.

Ya‘qūb bin Ibrāhīm ad-Dawraqī narrated to me, Ibn Abī Ḥāzim narrated to us, my father narrated to me, from Ibn ‘Umar, who said: **"The Qadariyyah are the Magians (Majūs) of this Ummah. If they fall ill, do not visit them, and if they die, do not attend their funerals."**⁹

⁸ Collected by at-Tirmidhī (2144) and the wording belongs to him, and [by] aṭ-Ṭūsī in *Mukhtaṣar al-Aḥkām* (1659), and [by] Ibn ‘Adī in *al-Kāmil fī aḍ-Ḍu‘afā’* (4/188) with a slight variation.

⁹ This ḥadīth was reported by Abū Dāwūd in his "Sunan" (4691), "The Book of the Sunnah – Chapter: Concerning al-Qadar" And likewise, it was reported by al-Ḥākim (286), al-Bayhaqī (21391), aṭ-Ṭabarānī in "al-Awsaṭ" (2494), al-Baghawī in "Sharḥ as-Sunnah" (1/78), Ibn ‘Asākir in "Tārīkh Dimashq" (19/62), Ibn Abī ‘Āṣim in "as-Sunnah" (268), and others, from the ḥadīth of Ibn ‘Umar (رضي الله عنهما). And it was graded authentic (*ṣaḥīḥ*) by Ibn al-Qaṭṭān in *Bayān al-Wahm wal-Īhām* (5/446), and it was graded good (*ḥasan*) by the Shaykh, al-Albānī in *Ṣaḥīḥ Abī Dāwūd* and other than it. And as-Saffārīnī said in *Lawā’ih al-Anwār*: "It is not less than being *ḥasan*."

The Statement Concerning the Companions of the Messenger of Allāh

(صلى الله عليه وسلم)

As for the truth regarding their differing over the best of the Companions of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم): It is that which came from him (صلى الله عليه وسلم) and which the *Salaḥ* consecutively followed in statement. And that is what Mūsā bin Sahl ar-Ramlī and Aḥmad bin Manṣūr bin Sayyār ar-Ramādī narrated to me, both saying: ‘Abdullāh bin Ṣāliḥ narrated to us, Nāfi‘ bin Yazīd narrated to me, from Zuhrah bin Ma‘bad, from Sa‘īd bin al-Musayyib, from Jābir bin ‘Abdullāh, who said: The Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said: "Verily, Allāh (جل وعلا)

Companions over all people, except for the Prophets and the Messengers. And He chose from my Companions Abū Bakr, ‘Umar, ‘Uthmān, and ‘Alī, may Allāh’s pleasure be upon them, and made them the best of my Companions, and in all of my Companions there is goodness. And He chose my Ummah over the rest of the nations, and He chose from my Ummah four generations after my Companions: the first generation, the second, and the third consecutively, and the fourth generation singly."¹⁰

And likewise, we say: The best of his (صلى الله عليه وسلم) Companions is: Aṣ-Ṣiddīq Abū Bakr (رضي الله عنه), then al-Fārūq after him, ‘Umar; then Dhū an-Nūrayn ‘Uthmān bin ‘Affān; then the Commander of the Believers and the Imām of the Muttaqīn, ‘Alī bin Abī Ṭālib, may the pleasure of Allāh be upon them all.

As for the most correct of statements with us concerning what they differed in regarding who among the Companions is most deserving of the Imāmate, it is the statement of the one who speaks with what Muḥammad bin ‘Umārah al-Asadī

¹⁰ The summary of the grading of the *Muḥaddith* is that in it [its chain of transmission] is ‘Abdullāh bin Ṣāliḥ, and this is one of the narrations rejected from him. As for the referencing (*Takhrīj*), it was collected by al-Ājurrī in *ash-Sharī‘ah* (1153), and Ibn Abī Zamanīn in *Uṣūl as-Sunnah* (191), and Abū Nu‘aym in *Faḍā’il al-Khulafā’ ar-Rāshidīn* (228) with a slight variation.

narrated to me, ‘Ubaydullāh bin Mūsā narrated to us, Ḥashraj bin Nubātah narrated to us, Sa‘īd bin Jumhān narrated to me, from Safīnah, the freed slave of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم):

that, it is a kingdom." Safīnah said to me: "Calculate: the Khilāfah of Abū Bakr was two years, the Khilāfah of ‘Umar was ten, the Khilāfah of ‘Uthmān was twelve, and the Khilāfah of ‘Alī was six." He said: "So I looked and found it to be thirty years."

The Statement Concerning Faith (Īmān), Its Increase and Decrease

As for the statement concerning Faith (Īmān), is it speech and action? And does it increase and decrease, or is there no increase in it and no decrease? Verily, the correct stance regarding it is the statement of the one who says: **It is speech and action, it increases and it decreases.** And with this the narration has come from a group from the Companions of the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم), and upon it the people of the Religion and virtue have proceeded.

Muḥammad bin ‘Alī bin al-Ḥasan bin Shaqīq narrated to us, saying: We asked Abū ‘Abdullāh Aḥmad bin Ḥanbal (رحمه الله) concerning Faith (Īmān), regarding the meaning of increase and decrease, so he said: al-Ḥasan bin Mūsā al-Ashyab narrated to us, Ḥammād bin Salamah narrated to us, from Abū Ja‘far al-Khaṭmī, from his father, from his grandfather ‘Umayr bin Ḥabīb who said: **"Faith increases and decreases."** So it was said: "And what is its increase, and what is its decrease?" He said: **"If we remember Allāh, praise Him, and glorify Him, then that is its increase. And if we become heedless, waste time, and forget, then that is its decrease."**¹¹

‘Alī bin Sahl ar-Ramlī narrated to us, al-Walīd bin Muslim narrated to us, saying: I heard al-Awzā‘ī, Mālik bin Anas, and Sa‘īd bin ‘Abd al-‘Azīz, may Allāh have mercy

¹¹ Collected by ‘Abdullāh bin Aḥmad in *as-Sunnah* (624), and Ibn Abī Shaybah (30963), and al-Ājurri in *ash-Sharī‘ah* (216), and the wording belongs to him. Ibn Taymiyyah stated in *Majmū‘ al-Fatāwā* (7/224): "It is famous (*mashhūr*)."

upon them, rejecting the statement of the one who says: "Verily, Faith is affirmation (*Iqrār*) without action." And they would say: **"There is no Faith except with action, and there is no action except with Faith."**¹²

The Pronunciation of the Qur'ān

As for the statement regarding the pronunciation (*Al-lafẓ*) of the servants of the Qur'ān, then there is no narration regarding it that we know of from a Companion who passed, nor a *Tābi'ī* who judged, except from the one in whose statement is sufficiency and healing—may the mercy of Allāh and His pleasure be upon him—and in following him is uprightness and guidance, and the one whose statement stands with us in the place of the statement of the early Imāms: **Abū 'Abdullāh Aḥmad bin Muḥammad bin Ḥanbal** (رضي الله عنه).

For indeed, Abū Ismā'īl at-Tirmidhī narrated to me, saying: I heard Abū 'Abdullāh Aḥmad bin Ḥanbal say: **"The *Lafẓiyyah* [those who say their pronunciation of the Qur'ān is created] are *Jahmiyyah*; due to the statement of Allāh, Majestic is His Name:**

حَتَّى يَسْمَعَ كَلِمَ اللَّهِ

{So that he may hear the words of Allāh} [9:6]

So from whom does he hear it?"

Then I heard a group of our companions whose names I do not memorize mentioning from him that he used to say: **"Whoever says: 'My pronunciation (*Lafẓī*) of the Qur'ān is created' is a *Jahmī*. And whoever says: 'It is uncreated' is an innovator (*Mubtadi'*)."**

¹² Collected by 'Abdullāh bin Aḥmad bin Ḥanbal in *as-Sunnah* (172, 462, 555, 557, 619, 644), and al-Ājurri in *ash-Sharī'ah* (243, 245, 247, 261, 263), and Abū Aḥmad al-Ḥākim in *Shi'ār Aṣḥāb al-Ḥadīth* (7, 9), and Ibn al-Muqri' in his *Mu'jam* (938), and al-Lālikā'ī in *Sharḥ Uṣūl I'tiqād Ahl as-Sunnah wal-Jamā'ah* (1394, 1396, 1398, 1400, 1401), and Abū Nu'aym al-Aṣbahānī in *Ḥilyat al-Awliyā'* (8351, 9138), and al-Bayhaqī in *as-Sunan al-Kabīr* (19199).

And there is no statement regarding that permissible for us to say, since we have no Imām to follow concerning it other than him, and in him is sufficiency and prevention, and he is the followed Imām, may the mercy of Allāh and His pleasure be upon him.

As for the discussion of the essence of the named: Is it what it defines or something other than that? This is a foolish and newly invented matter that has no basis to follow, and there is no statement from an Imām to listen to. Engaging in it is abhorrent, and remaining silent is commendable. A person should be satisfied with what knowledge he has regarding it, and his speech should lead him to the statement of Allāh, the Exalted in His praise, which is the true statement:

قُلْ أَدْعُوا اللَّهَ أَوْ ادْعُوا الرَّحْمَنَ أَيًّا مَا تَدْعُوا فَلَهُ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَىٰ وَلَا تَجْهَرُوا بِصَلَاتِكُمْ وَلَا تَخَافُتُمْ بِهَا وَابْتَغِ بَيْنَ ذَلِكَ سَبِيلًا

{Say, "Call upon Allah or call upon the Most Merciful. Whichever [name] you call - to Him belong the best names." And do not recite [too] loudly in your prayer or [too] quietly but seek between that an [intermediate] way.} [17:110]

And His statement the Exalted:

وَلِلَّهِ الْأَسْمَاءُ الْحُسْنَىٰ فَادْعُوهُ بِهَا

{And to Allah belong the best names, so invoke Him by them.} [7:180]

And that he knows that his Lord is the One who ascended over the Throne.

لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا وَمَا تَحْتَ الثَّرَىٰ

{To Him belongs what is in the heavens and what is on the earth and what is between them and what is under the soil.} [20:6]

So whoever surpasses that has indeed failed, lost, gone astray, and perished. So let the one present among you, O people, convey to whoever is far from us and remote, or close and near, that what we worship Allāh with regarding the things we have mentioned is what we have clarified to you upon our description. So whoever narrates from us contrary to that, or attributes to us other than it, or falsely ascribes to us a statement besides it, then he is a lying fabricator, a conjecturing transgressor. He returns with the wrath of Allāh, and upon him is the anger of Allāh and His curse in

both abodes. And it is a right upon Allāh that He leads him to the watering place that the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) led his equivalents to, and that He settles him in the abode that the Prophet of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) informed that Allāh will settle his likes in, based upon what he (صلى الله عليه وسلم) informed.

Severe Warnings Against Innovations, Backbiting, and Harming the Muslims

Abū Jaʿfar said: And that is what Abū Kurayb narrated to us, al-Muḥāribī narrated to us, from Ismāʿīl bin ʿAyyāsh al-Ḥimṣī, from Thaʿlabah bin Muslim al-Khathʿamī, from Ayyūb bin Bushayr al-ʿIjlī, from Shufayy bin Mātiʿ al-Aṣbaḥī, who said: The Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said: **"Four people will harm the people of the Fire on top of what they are in of harm: they will run between the boiling water and the Hellfire, calling out for doom and destruction. The people of the Fire will say to one another: 'What is the matter with these people, they have harmed us on top of what we are in of harm?' A man closed upon inside a coffin of hot coals; a man dragging his intestines; a man whose mouth is pouring pus and blood; and a man eating his own flesh.**

So it will be said to the companion of the coffin: 'What is the matter with the distant one [the wretched one], he has harmed us on top of what we are in of harm?' He will say: 'Verily, the distant one died while the wealth of the people was on his neck.' And it will be said to the one dragging his intestines: 'What is the matter with the distant one, he has harmed us on top of what we are in of harm?' He will say: 'Verily, the distant one used to not care if urine got on him, he would not wash it.' And it will be said to the one whose mouth is pouring pus and blood: 'What is the matter with the distant one, he has harmed us on top of what we are in of harm?' He will say: 'Verily, the distant one used to look at every word of ugly Bidʿah (innovation) and take pleasure in it, just as one takes pleasure

in foul speech (*Rafath*).¹³ And it will be said to the one eating his own flesh: 'What is the matter with the distant one, he has harmed us on top of what we are in of harm?' He will say: 'Verily, the distant one used to walk with tale-bearing (*Namimah*) and eat the flesh of the people.'¹³

Khallād bin Aslam narrated to us, from an-Naḍr bin Shumayl bin Ḥarashah, from Mūsā bin 'Uqbah, from 'Umar bin 'Abdullāh al-Anṣārī, from Abū ad-Dardā', from the Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم): **"Whoever mentions a person with what is not in him in order to find fault with him, Allāh will imprison him in Hell until he proves the truth of what he said about him."**¹⁴

Muḥammad bin 'Awf aṭ-Ṭā'ī and Muḥammad bin Muslim ar-Rāzī narrated to us, both saying: Abū al-Mughīrah 'Abd al-Quddūs bin al-Ḥajjāj narrated to us, Ṣafwān bin 'Amr narrated to us, saying: Rāshid bin Sa'd and 'Abd ar-Raḥmān bin Jubayr bin Nufayr narrated to me, from Anas bin Mālik, who said: The Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said: **"When I was taken up into the heavens, I passed by a people who had nails of copper, scratching their chests. So I said: 'Who are these, O Jibrīl?' He**

¹³ Regarding the evaluation of the narrators within this *isnād*: Abū Kurayb is *thiqah* (trustworthy and precise). As for al-Muḥāribī, he was declared *thiqah* by the Imām, Yaḥyā bin Ma'īn; however, Yaḥyā also noted that he narrated *manākīr* (rejected reports) from *majhūl* (unknown) narrators, which spoiled his ḥadīth, while Abū Ḥātim graded him as *ṣadūq* (truthful). Concerning Ismā'īl bin 'Ayyāsh, his condition requires *tafṣīl* (detailed elaboration); the Imāms of Ḥadīth have clarified that his narrations from his own people (the people of Shām) are authentic, whereas his narrations from the people of the Ḥijāz and 'Irāq are weak and confused. Regarding Tha'labah bin Muslim, Ibn Ḥibbān mentioned him in his work *ath-Thiqāt* (The Trustworthy Narrators), and there is not much else preserved concerning his condition. As for Ayyūb bin Bushayr, he was declared *thiqah* by Abū Dāwūd, Ibn Sa'd, and the Ḥāfiẓ, adh-Dhahabī (رحمهم الله). Finally, concerning Shufayy bin Māti', an-Nasā'ī provided *tawthīq* (a declaration of reliability) for him, and Ibn Ḥibbān likewise included him in *ath-Thiqāt*.

¹⁴ Collected by aṭ-Ṭabarānī in *al-Mu'jam al-Awsaṭ* (no. 8758) and *al-Mu'jam aṣ-Ṣaghīr* (no. 1154). it is *ḍa'īf*. Shaykh al-Albānī (رحمه الله) evaluated it as weak in *Ghāyat al-Marām* (no. 430) and *Ḍa'īf al-Jāmi'* (no. 5563), clarifying that its *isnād* contains multiple defects, including the presence of Miqdām bin Dāwūd ar-Ru'aynī and 'Amr bin 'Abdillāh al-Awdī, both of whom possess weakness in their narrations. However, the foundational threat (*al-Wa'id*) mentioned within this text is rigorously authenticated by the famous ḥadīth of 'Abdullāh bin 'Umar (رضي الله عنهما) collected by Abū Dāwūd in his *Sunan* (no. 3597) and Imām Aḥmad in his *Musnad* (no. 5385).

said: 'These are the ones who eat the flesh of the people, and defame their reputations.'¹⁵

‘Alī bin Sahl ar-Ramlī narrated to us, al-Walīd bin Muslim narrated to us, from ‘Uthmān bin Abī al-‘Ātikah, from Abū Umāmah (رضي الله عنه) who said: **The Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) came to the graveyard of Baqī‘ al-Gharqad and stood over two moist [newly dug] graves, and said: "Did you bury so-and-so and so-and-so here?" Or he said: "so-and-so and so-and-so?" So they said: "Yes, O Messenger of Allāh." He said: "So-and-so has been sat up right now and is being struck." Then he said: "By the One in whose Hand is my soul, he was struck a blow such that no limb remained on him except that it was severed, and his grave flared up with fire, and he let out a scream heard by the creation except the two weighty ones from the Jinn and mankind. And were it not for the confusion (*tamrīj*) of your hearts and your excessive talking, you would hear what I hear." Then he said: "Now this one is being struck, now this one is being struck." Then he said: "By the One in whose Hand is my soul, he was struck a blow such that no bone remained on him except that it was severed, and his grave flared up with fire, and he let out a scream heard by the creation except the two weighty ones from the Jinn and mankind. And were it not for confusion in your hearts and your excessive talking, you would hear what I hear." They said: "O Messenger of Allāh, what was their sin?" He said: "As for so-and-so, then he used to not purify himself from urine. And as for so-and-so—or the female so-and-so—he used to eat the flesh of the people."**¹⁶

¹⁵ Collected by Abū Dāwūd in his *Sunan* (4878) under the "Book of General Behavior (*al-Adab*) – Chapter: Regarding Backbiting (*al-Ghībah*)". And it was likewise collected by Imām Aḥmad in his *Musnad* (13340), Abū Ya‘lā in his *Musnad* (3187), and al-Bayhaqī in *Shu‘ab al-Īmān* (6752). Shaykh al-Albānī (رحمه الله) graded it authentic (*ṣaḥīḥ*) in *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Jāmi‘* (5213) and *As-Silsilah aṣ-Ṣaḥīḥah* (533).

¹⁶ This specific narration was collected by Imām Aḥmad in his *Musnad* (5/266, no. 22292), and aṭ-Ṭabarānī in *al-Mu‘jam al-Kabīr* (8/216, no. 7869) and *al-Mu‘jam al-Awsaṭ* (no. 6274). All of them narrate it via the route of al-Walīd bin Muslim. The chain of transmission (*isnād*) cited here by aṭ-Ṭabarī contains an apparent omission (*inqiṭā‘*). ‘Uthmān bin Abī al-‘Ātikah did not hear directly from Abū Umāmah; rather, his narrations from him are via the intermediary of ‘Alī bin Yazīd from al-Qāsim, as is correctly preserved in the *Musnad* of Imām Aḥmad.

Muḥammad bin Yazīd ar-Rifāʿī narrated to us, Ibn Fuḍayl narrated to us, [H] and Muḥammad bin al-ʿAlāʾ narrated to us, Aswad bin ʿĀmir narrated to us, Abū Bakr bin ʿAyyāsh narrated to us, all of them from al-Aʿmash, from Saʿīd bin ʿAbdullāh, from Abū Barzah al-Aslamī, who said: The Messenger of Allāh (صلى الله عليه وسلم) said to us: **"O assembly of those who have believed with their tongues but Faith has not entered their hearts: do not backbite the Muslims, and do not seek out their faults. For verily, whoever seeks out their faults, Allāh will seek out his fault; and whoever Allāh seeks out his fault, He will expose him even in the privacy of his own house."**¹⁷

[End of Book]

¹⁷ Collected by Abū Dāwūd in his *Sunan* (no. 4880) under the "Book of General Behavior (*al-Adab*) – Chapter: Regarding Backbiting (*al-Ghibah*)". It was likewise collected by Imām Aḥmad in his *Musnad* (no. 19776), Abū Yaʿlā in his *Musnad* (no. 7423), and al-Bayhaqī in *Shuʿab al-Īmān* (no. 6741). It was graded *ḥasan ṣaḥīḥ* by the Shaykh al-Albānī (رحمه الله) in *Ṣaḥīḥ Abī Dāwūd* (no. 4880), *Ghāyat al-Marām* (no. 418), and *Ṣaḥīḥ al-Jāmiʿ* (no. 7984).